

Renee Harris

## The Capture Project

### 1. **Working Title:**

Predicting the future of GLP-1s and the possibility of a cultural shift.

### 2. **Thesis:**

GLP-1s are proving they can genuinely change lives—but whether they're a lasting medical breakthrough or just the next health fad depends on factors we don't have the full picture on yet. We're still figuring out how safe they really are long-term, who can actually access them, and whether people can use them without it backfiring. Lap-Bands were sold as the perfect solution for weight loss that were going to help everyone, but a couple decades later, we know that they have less than a 20% success rate. On the other side, Viagra began its life as a simple blood pressure treatment but went on to make huge, lasting waves. What fate will GLP-1s have in the long term? My goal is that by the end of this project, I will be able to make an educated argument for one side or the other.

### 3. **The Capture Rule:**

Is the GLP-1 phenomenon the beginning of a paradigm shift or are we in the middle of a fad that will eventually fade away?

My goal throughout this project is to be exposed to a variety of both scientific and anecdotal evidence to form as broad and as clear a picture as possible. If it makes a factual claim about GLP-1 outcomes (efficacy, side effects, long-term use, behavior, economics) and isn't trying to sell something, it will be worth capturing, regardless of which side it argues. Things that may almost count but don't would be advertisements for GLP-1s, anecdotes with no numbers behind them ("my cousin lost 40 pounds and felt amazing") as these are really just data points about individuals, not necessarily the trend. Think-pieces and cultural commentary ("GLP-1s and the end of diet culture") almost count but are opinions about meaning, not evidence about the drug. They may be worth capturing for the "paradigm shift" half of my question, but not as scientific evidence. I'm going to absorb as much as I can but I will refrain from capturing evidence that is explicitly biased.

#### **4. Plan of Capture Action:**

I plan to visit social media sites (i.e. YouTube, Reddit, Facebook, Instagram) and read articles or watch videos that speak to the topic of GLP-1s and their impact on our society. I plan to do this daily at night. If I miss a day here and there, I don't know that it will have an extreme impact on the outcome of the project but gathering a sufficient number of screenshots to gain enough knowledge on the subject so that I can make the assessment to support my thesis will be important. I will more than likely capture additional screenshots during the week if I've missed one. If I approach this project from a categorical stand point, I may have screenshots that may not fit into a particular category but the information is relevant to the overall project.

#### **5. What This Should Do for a Reader?**

By the end of this project, the reader should be able to see the impact of GLP-1s from different angles. The information provided should give the reader different points-of-view to make a well-informed decision on this topic. Because the capture rule pulls in evidence on both sides of the paradigm-shift-vs-fad question, readers should come away understanding why this is potentially still an open question, not just what side I landed on.

#### **6. Guardrails**

If anything I observe inspires me to reach out with follow-up questions, I'll be sure to communicate with the creator and let them know that this work is part of a project for a graduate course and get their permission before posting anything. Given this topic, I do not anticipate posting anything that would be deemed inappropriate to share with the class.